Dacarbazine — metastatic melanoma

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00464 · Draft source reconciliation; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Taking or receiving treatment

The NCCP dose is dacarbazine 850 mg/m² on day 1 in one litre of saline over one hour, with the infusion protected from light. The individual dose is prescribed using body size and clinical review. Allow extra time for blood results, anti-sickness medicine, preparation and any other fluids. Tell the nurse immediately about pain, burning, swelling or redness around the infusion.

STEP 2

Missed, vomited or held treatment

If treatment is delayed for low blood counts, illness or another problem, the team sets the new date and dose. Do not mark a planned but cancelled dose as received. The six-cycle limit is conditional on benefit and tolerability, not a requirement to give unsafe treatment.

STEP 3

Appointments and supply

Before each visit, check four things: the blood-test booking, how you will get there, your medicine supply and any help you need. Ask who will review the results and tell you whether the next dose can go ahead.

STEP 4

Paper copies and contacts

Keep the handbook, short guide and treatment card in one place. Ask your team to fill in the real daytime and emergency numbers and print a replacement when the plan changes. A phone is optional.

Sources: NCCP 00464 v3: current regimen source. Draft source reconciliation; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.